Faculty Member Name: _Mitch Halloran_

SELF-EVALUATION

Fall 2025

1. **Assess how you are meeting the duties and responsibilities of the position (see attached AR 7122, and** AAUP Ethical Standards Statement as noted in **SCFT Part-Time contract, Article 12, Section 1, Part B.1.b.i**).

   Provided during my employee onboarding, SCCCD Administrative Regulation (AR) 7122, as amended 18 Aug 2008, specifies 29 duties and responsibilities (D&Rs) for those with instructor roles.

   The first of these D&Rs is the mission, values, and vision statements of the College which should never be overlooked but which should be re-read such that faculty and students are reminded of their commitments to uphold the principles stated therein. [https://www.fresnocitycollege.edu/about/mission-statement.html]

   The other D&Rs inform instructors:

   (i) to maintain their discipline: as a chemistry instructor, it means to keep up with news and the science of chemistry that would be relevant to the learning for the students who enroll in Chemistry 3A or any other courses;

   (ii) improve their pedagogical approach not just with each semester, but with each academic week and day, especially where it is deficient and wanting and in need of immediate remedy. This includes looking for opportunities for professional development offered by the District and College, trying to incorporate advice and recommendations by the offices of the District and College for better teaching. It also means prioritizing the advice and recommendations of peer instructors teaching the 3A course as well as constructive criticism of other colleagues on general approaches to teaching;

   (iii) as a part-time instructor (and where permitted), communicate with Department and Division colleagues to suggest or to participate in activities that improve administration and operations and the delivery of the teaching/learning objective of all entities within the District (that is, from the Department to District level). As to communication, it should be in multiple ways: verbally and especially if it is urgent, and in writing (by electronic mail) especially in followup to ensure the message is not lost and ensure it is available, and to the relevant individuals, who will use their best judgment to widen the circle of those to be involved when necessary in the issue

   (iv) take care of the many specifics of the D&Rs to protect the College in its assets (including property) that are vital to teaching and facilitating the learning of students effectively

   (v) to be constantly mindful that the goal and purpose of the instructor is to put the student first, to listen to the student when the student especially says "I need help" with the assumption that such words could convey to the instructor that a need is not being met

and special attention is required, whether it is a specific effort for the student or a general reassessment of teaching methods for the entire class

2. Describe any challenges and opportunities you have had since your last evaluation.

As I am new to SCCCD/Fresno City College this Fall 2025 semester and have had one peer evaluation this semester, I can address from that perspective. While I have had previous experience as an instructor to help alleviate the many challenges that would be presented to someone entering for the first time the career as college-level instructor, and I am a native Californian actually born in Fresno but having returned to the area after an extended time, I am nonetheless in fully immersive learning mode as if I was new to the location, to the culture, to society, to different generations.

If I were to describe in necessary detail what the ***challenges*** are, they would be listed as follows in order priority and importance:

(i) Understand and implement the objectives, and course of record (COR) of the course, Chemistry 3A, of Fresno City College

(ii) Within the immediate future--that is, in teaching this course for the next semester--implementing all and not just some of the items needing improvement cited by my peer evaluator. These are detailed somewhat in Item 4 of this self-evaluation.

If I were to describe in necessary detail what the ***opportunities*** are for me, the list would be this:

(i) having a peer instructor evaluator as well as full-time instructor course mentor for being properly launched into the pedagogical approach and methods for teaching in general at the College and specifically for effective teaching of this course. Without this peer assistance, the path to realizing the required potential to teach this particular course effectively such that students get an instructor's best effort would be long in terms of number of semesters. Students in the next semester I hope will benefit from the improvement I will make which would not happen if I were faced with figuring things out entirely on my own.

(ii) having the District set up career education and professional training events like seminars or course series to provide instructors skills beyond their disciplinary mandate, such as certification in distance education that also has useful skills for instructors in a traditional (in-person) setting. These offerings by the District and the College include experts within and outmade aware of tools and technologies for instructors to be more effective in the classroom, whether in the use of media or

(iii) having departmental colleagues who are making use of tools and technologies the delivery of the content of their courses and whose activities I can observe with the thought, "hey, what my colleague is doing is absolutely something I will make use of in my own teaching"

3. Describe significant accomplishments since your last evaluation.

Even before my first peer evaluation or this first self-evaluation, I had the significant accomplishment of getting a critique from a student in lecture (a student who struggles in the course) on how to be a better lecturer. The student wanted me to see when I needed

to get away from the PowerPoint projections in lecture, and to grab the marker and go to the whiteboard in elaboration of a concept I was addressing in lecture, and in saying things in another way when what I was talking about what not truly getting through to the many of them. The significant accomplishment was in my making a (radical?) change in lecture style.

My next significant accomplishment will be in using lecture time in having students do in-class exercises so they are propelled into active learning and less in passive learning: not just showing them problems and how to solve them in slides, but doing in-lecture quizzes, something almost never done when I was a student in general chemistry (expectations were different in my learning days). I am admittedly in a pedagogical rut that I need to get out of. I have this awareness and now must find a way to get out of it that balances teaching in lecture with basically setting up a homework period within lecture.

I recently communicated with another P/T instructor on this matter of delivering lectures, and I feel I have to spend time observing at least one lecture of two, maybe three, different 3A instructors to see how they are teaching the students with the use of setting aside time away from just lecturing in the "traditional" (outdated?) way and in engaging the students and not watching them doze off.

4. Identify goals you expect to accomplish before your next evaluation.

My peer evaluator was instrumental in providing this list of goals to be achieved hopefully in short order:

(i) Inefficient Use of Time during lecture. It was recommended that the lecture presentation (from PowerPoint slide prompting) needs heavy revising to deal with the issues in the assigned online textbook for the course. The lecture presentation is basically a "linear" delivery of content from the online text, which lacks consistency often by mentioning concepts suddenly to students and then actually introducing those concepts later in a following chapter, which means in a following lecture. The lack of consistency in the lecturing is thus a reflection of the lack of consistency in the online textbook, and the evaluator was properly annoyed by attempts during lecture to try to take time to (back)fill in the introductory material for a concept suddenly mentioned, causing an inefficient use of time. This requires a complete revision of lecture content that is not textbook-based in a linear delivery of that book, but which is subject-based. This will also ultimately and properly reduce the number of slides which actually involve repeating concepts in chemistry from an earlier lecture to a later lecture. The peer evaluator--who I believe is not a fan of the course text--mentioned another OER text that I think he uses and I will attempt to revise the lecture content to his recommendation.

(ii) Need to Better Engage Students. The peer evaluator wants me during lecture to improve upon giving the students time to respond in lecture about a concept presented to them, then asking someone to answer something like what I call a "practice exam" question and not being so quick to give them the answer, but to provide the time for them thinking about how to solve the problem.

(iii) This is not peer evaluator critique as (i) and (ii) are. But I realize that I believe I should use a laser pointer in lecture. I was thinking about my style of lecturing and in order to implement more engagement with students (item [ii]), I think I have to wander around the lecture room and make strong eye contact with students to encourage them to speak or raise their hand to speak in answering questions that are generally posed to the entire

class. Because I will be some distance from the projector screens that show slides in being among the students in lecture, a good laser pointer and the ability to change slides with a remote device (I need to figure that part out) I think might be a minor aspect leading to improved teaching

5. **Describe your progress toward, diversity, equity, inclusion and accessibility (DEIA)-related competencies, and teaching and learning practices that reflect DEIA and anti-racist principles. How do these reflect knowledge of the intersectionality of social identities, and illustrate your skills for effective cross-cultural teaching. How do you recognize the myriad of ways in which people differ, including the psychological, physical, cognitive, and social differences that occur among individuals. Finally, how do the above impact improved equitable student outcomes and course completion in your classes. (see SCFT Part-Time contract, Article 12, Section 1, Part B.1, Subpart a.4).**

   (i) I look for professional training and development opportunities from the District, the College, and elsewhere that specifically inform me on the subject of the needs of people who have been identified as being shut out from opportunities and advantages that have been denied to them and have been privileges easily obtained by others in a system that may not treat groups fairly, and possibly by design.

   (ii) Communication with students: I realize as a part-time instructor with no office available, I must remind students frequently that their avenues of connecting with me are to send email messages and also to help me in setting up online interactive (Zoom) meetings to engage in virtual office hours with them outside of also the traditional office hours accorded to P/T instructors in an arranged campus setting. This is particularly necessary for individuals who may have experiences where they may have been (routinely) ignored in their requests for help and extra efforts must be taken to encourage them to speak up for themselves and not be at all shy in raising their hand, saying, "I'm here"

   (iii) Be cognizant of the words I use and the thoughts I express when standing before students in lecture and laboratory. Be restrained in bringing up personal anecdotes about learning in general and learning chemistry in particular. It is easy to relate an anecdote that is barely tangential to the lecture topic(s) at hand, and which could veer off into offending students. I know that my experiences of life are not only a possible benefit but could also be a burden in the way these could affect my ability to perceive what others experience in their lives. I must examine any weaknesses in my character that lead me to express unacceptable judgmental stereotypes in communicating with students, and I must be on guard to make sure I reform my thinking so that such views are consistent with what is truth and reality, and that they are constructive and not destructive.

   (iv) The way I learned and was taught general chemistry a generation or two ago is radically distinct from the way teaching and learning is done today. In the intervening years many improvements have been focused on improving the sensitivity and empathy instructors and students must have for each other and to peers and colleagues, in ways to further the goals of maximizing trust and respect. A professor/instructor must not ever adopt the mantra: "I have been teaching this way for years, and I judge it to be successful. I see no reason to consider changes or modifications to my way of doing things." The only thing an instructor should not change is saying "My way is to be open to new ways of teaching and understanding how students learn [better]. When a new way is presented to

me, I promise to evaluate it thoroughly, not cursorily, and fairly, even being ready to provide a list of the pros and cons of it, before I make a judgment to adopt it in an effort to improve, or to set it aside for the moment with a proper explanation of my reasoning."

(v) I must make sure I have not lost the experiences I have had in cross-cultural interaction. I lived for nearly two decades outside of the United States, in a culture quite different than the one I grew up and lived in. In that culture I have been the target of bigotry, stereotypical judgments, insults and other abuse. This should particularly raise my sensitivity to ensuring I do not subject others to such negative behavior.

Signature: _____ Date 25 Nov 2025